

Miguel Ortiz

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ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

University of British Columbia

Assistant Professor, Vancouver School of Economics

2025 – Present

Princeton University

Postdoctoral Research Associate, Research Program in Development Economics

2024 – 2025

EDUCATION

University of California, Berkeley

Ph.D., Business and Public Policy group at the Haas School of Business

2018 – 2024

Committee: Ernesto Dal Bó, Francesco Trebbi, Frederico Finan, Edward Miguel

Universidad de los Andes (Bogotá, Colombia)

B.A. in Economics with minor in Philosophy, summa cum laude (ranked 1st)

2012 – 2017

PUBLICATIONS

“Monopoly of Taxation Without a Monopoly of Violence: The Weak State’s Trade-Offs from Taxation”

with Soeren Henn, Mastaki Mugaruka, Raúl Sánchez de la Sierra and David Qihang Wu

Review of Economic Studies, 2024

WORKING PAPERS

“Hate, Fear and Intergroup Conflict: Experimental Evidence from Nigeria”

– Winner of the Weiss Family Distinguished Paper at NEUDC 2023

R&R Quarterly Journal of Economics

“Fear Traps: Evidence from Segregated Markets in Nigeria”

with Eunice B. Atajiri

WORK IN PROGRESS

“Business Practices from Foreign Cultures: Evidence from Ethiopia”

with Shibiru Ayalew and David Q. Wu

“Dignity and Costly Punishment: Evidence from Labor Courts”

with Chris Blattman, Joyce Sadka and Enrique Seira

“Seeing the State: Elite Exposure to Public Goods and the Fiscal Contract”

with Chris Blattman and Jose A. Guerra

AWARDS & GRANTS

Stone Research Grant, The Stone Centre on Inequality, \$20,000 CAD, 2026

Hampton Research Grant, The Hampton Fund, \$15,000 CAD, 2026

Stone Research Grant, The Stone Centre on Inequality, \$25,000 CAD, 2025

Weiss Research Grant, The Weiss Fund, \$70,000 USD, 2025

IGC Exploratory Grant, The International Growth Center, £20,000 GBP, 2024

ACES Dissertation Fellowship, Assoc. for Comparative Econ Studies, \$40,000 USD, 2023

N2PE Research Grant, Network for a New Political Economy, \$5,000 USD, 2023

IGC Full Research Grant, The International Growth Center, £52,000 GBP, 2023

Weiss Pilot Grant, The Weiss Fund, \$8,000 USD, 2023

CEGA Development Economics Challenge, Center for Effective Global Action, \$15,000 USD, 2022

ACES Research Award, Association for Comparative Economic Studies, \$20,000 USD, 2022

EGAL Research Grant, Center for Equity, Gender, and Leadership, \$5,000 USD, 2022

Peter Jones Memorial Fund Grant, Institute for Business Innovation, \$4,500 USD, 2021

Portafolio Prize, Best Student in Economics or Business in Colombia, Honorable Mention, 2017

Academic Excellence Prize (×2), Universidad de los Andes, Fall 2015 and Spring 2016

TEACHING

PhD Political Economy

UBC, Fall 2025

BA Seminar in Applied Economics

UBC, Fall 2025

OTHER

Referee: *Econometrica*, *Quarterly Journal of Economics*, *American Economic Review*, *Journal of Public Economics*, *Journal of Development Economics*, *Journal of Health Economics*, *Nature Communications*, *Economic Development and Cultural Change*, *Swiss National Science Foundation*, *Defense and Peace Economics*, *Studies in Comparative International Development*

Seminars and Conference: **(2026)** Universidad de los Andes, University of Toronto, University of South Carolina, Brown University, University of Chicago (Development Seminar) **(2025)** West Point Social Science Conference, Rutgers University, Princeton University, IIES-Stockholm, Paris School of Economics, Empirical Microeconomics Workshop at Banff **(2024)** Stockholm University, University of British Columbia, Nova SBE, Universidad del Rosario, Northwestern Political Economy Rookiefest, ESOC Annual Conference, Transatlantic Political Economy Conference (HEC Montreal, McGill, King's College), Columbia University **(2023)** NEUDC (Harvard), Economic Development, Political Economy, and Culture Conference (UCLA & CIFAR), WGAPE, Berkeley Conference on Political Economy and Governance

Languages: Spanish (native), English (fluent), French (intermediate)